

SUPPORT

SUPPORTS TERTIARY HOW

FOR WHY-WHAT · WHAT-WHY

The Detail Debt Log

A running capture list for details consciously deferred in the moment, reviewed on a fixed weekly rhythm. **Deferring stops turning into dropping.**

THE DRAIN

In the flow of purpose and progress work, small details surface constantly: a number to verify, a person to loop in, a setting to change. Handling each one in the moment breaks momentum; ignoring them means they vanish. Tertiary HOW profiles lose these details not through carelessness but because nothing catches them.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The log is the catch. Any detail you choose not to handle now goes on the list in one line, with enough context to act on later. A fixed weekly review clears the list in a single batch, at a time you chose, instead of details resurfacing as surprises at the worst moments.

What a log entry captures

- | | |
|--------------------------|--|
| 1 The detail | One line, specific enough that future-you knows exactly what it means. |
| 2 Where it lives | The doc, thread, or system it belongs to. |
| 3 What breaks if dropped | Honest stakes. Some details can genuinely be let go. |
| 4 Clear-by date | When it stops being deferrable. |

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 **Keep the log one gesture away.** A pinned note, a card in your tracker. Friction kills capture.
- 2 **Capture instead of handling.** In the moment, one line on the log. Momentum stays intact.
- 3 **Clear it weekly, in one batch.** Thirty minutes, same time each week. Batch-clearing details costs far less than scattered handling.
- 4 **Prune honestly.** If something has rolled three weeks and nothing broke, cross it off on purpose.

WHAT IT WON'T DO

The log does not do the details, and the weekly clearing session will still be draining work; schedule it at a high-energy time and keep it short. What it removes is the second, worse cost: details lost entirely and discovered by someone else.

IN THE KIT

Log template (print + digital)

Weekly review ritual card

Prune criteria

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 5 Timeboxed Detail Sprints · **Tool 3** The Last 10% Protocol · **Tool 31** Energy Budget Planner